

C U R R I C U L U M D E S I G N

Leadership Readiness Pathway

Program-level curriculum design · Portfolio project

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1 Program Rationale

Most leadership training targets people who are already managers. This program is designed one step earlier, for high-performing individual contributors being considered for promotion into a people-management role. The goal isn't to make them experts on day one of the program; it's to build the foundational judgment skills that make someone ready to step into leadership, so the transition itself goes smoother for them, their future team, and the org.

Target audience: Employees identified as promotion-track / high-potential (HiPo), not yet in a formal leadership role.

Program goal: By the end of the pathway, learners can apply core people-leadership behaviors, including coaching, delegating, navigating hard conversations, and thinking at a business/strategic level, before they're formally accountable for a team.

Terminal learning objective: By the end of the Leadership Readiness Pathway, promotion-track individual contributors will be able to **evaluate** realistic people-leadership scenarios spanning coaching, delegation, conflict, and resourcing trade-offs and **select** the response that reflects sound managerial judgment, avoiding the failure patterns modelled at each module's decision points.

2 Why This Module Sequence

The four modules are ordered by interpersonal complexity, not by topic convenience. Each one assumes the judgment built in the one before it:

1. **Coaching & Feedback** comes first because it's the most foundational one-on-one skill: recognizing a problem and responding supportively, without yet needing to manage competing priorities or conflict.
2. **Delegation & Trust-Building** builds on that. It requires the same read-the-person skill as coaching, plus the added complexity of letting go of control.
3. **Difficult Conversations & Conflict Navigation** is harder still, combining coaching-level empathy with higher emotional stakes and disagreement.
4. **Strategic Decision-Making & Business Acumen** comes last because it shifts from interpersonal judgment to organizational judgment. It's the leap from "managing a person" to "managing outcomes," which is what promotion readiness ultimately signals.

3 Curriculum Map

#	Module	Core Skill	Bloom's	Format	Est. Time	Status
1	Coaching & Feedback	Recognise early signs of performance-related stress; select a supportive coaching response over a directive or dismissive one	Analyse / Evaluate	Branching scenario + knowledge checks	6–8 min	Fully built
2	Delegation & Trust-Building	Decide what to delegate, to whom, and how much oversight to retain	Analyse	Branching scenario (outline)	6–8 min (est.)	Storyboard-level
3	Difficult Conversations & Conflict Navigation	Navigate a disagreement or hard message without avoiding it or escalating it	Evaluate	Branching scenario (outline)	8–10 min (est.)	Storyboard-level
4	Strategic Decision-Making & Business Acumen	Weigh a decision's impact beyond the immediate team (cost, timeline, stakeholders)	Evaluate / Create	Case study + decision sim (outline)	8–10 min (est.)	Concept-level

Modules 2–4 are intentionally left at outline/storyboard level

4 Module 1 Design Notes: Coaching & Feedback

Learning objective: By the end of this module, learners will be able to **analyse** early indicators of performance-related stress in a team member and **select** a coaching response that supports the individual, over one that is directive or dismissive.

This is the only fully built module in the pathway, so it carries the most design weight. A few decisions worth calling out:

- **Assessed via a decision-path, not a single correct-answer question.** “Choosing a supportive coaching response” is a judgment skill, not a recall fact, so the scenario branches based on the learner's choice, with consequences that play out realistically rather than an immediate right/wrong flag.
- **Interaction complexity is mapped to cognitive demand.** Remember/Understand-level content (recognizing terminology, definitions) uses closed recognition checks; Analyse/Evaluate-level content (choosing how to respond) uses consequence-based branching. This mapping is stated once here and carried through as the design principle for Modules 2–4.
- **Decision Point 2 is informed by the learner's path through Decision Point 1.** The scenario adapts based on earlier choices, so two learners who choose differently at the start see meaningfully different consequences later, not just a different label on the same outcome.
- **The module closes with a variable-driven personalised summary, not a pass/fail score.** This suits a soft-skill module where the goal is reflection and behavior change, not certification.

5 What This Project Demonstrates

- **Program/curriculum architecture:** sequencing modules by cognitive and interpersonal complexity, not just topic
- **Depth over breadth in execution:** one module built to full production quality, with the remaining structure mapped out clearly enough that a stakeholder could greenlight the rest
- **Consistent assessment philosophy across a program:** the Bloom's-to-interaction mapping (recognition checks for Remember/Understand, branching for Analyse/Evaluate) is stated once at the program level and carried through all 4 modules, not re-justified each time